

Maria Ayaz

PHD APPLICANT IN EDUCATION | THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

Mardan, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan | ☎ +92 311 9179224 | ✉ mariakhan6900@gmail.com

LinkedIn | Google Scholar | Portfolio

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Education

Universitas Islam Internasional Indonesia (UIII)

Depok, Indonesia

2022 – 2024 (conferred 29 Aug 2024)

- CGPA 3.79 / 4.00. Fully funded international scholarship. Medium of instruction: English.
- Thesis (6 credits, A-) and Thesis Proposal (3 credits, A-), 9 of 44 program credits: “Navigating Leadership in the Era of the Single National Curriculum in Pakistan: A Case Study of Strategies and Challenges in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Schools.” Qualitative case study: semi-structured Zoom interviews with 12 public-school principals in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (equal numbers from urban and rural schools, purposive sampling), triangulated through teacher validation interviews and online questionnaires; interview guides developed in English and translated into Urdu and Pashto; thematic analysis (Braun & Clarke). Supervisors: Dr Destina Wahyu Winarti and Dr Bambang Sumintono. hdl.handle.net/20.500.14576/293
- Relevant courses: Educational Management and Leadership (A-); Educational Policy Analysis (A); Educational Research Methodology (A-); Statistical Analysis (A); Educational Assessment (A).

Bachelor of Studies in English

Abdul Wali Khan University Mardan (AWKUM)

Mardan, Pakistan

2014 – 2018 (result declared 6 Sep 2018)

- CGPA 3.53 / 4.00 (82%); 130 credit hours. Medium of instruction: English.
- Final-year research project, defended at viva voce: “Depression as a Serious Human Dilemma in the Novel *Moth Smoke* by Mohsin Hamid” (later published; see Publications).
- Relevant courses: Research Methodology; Introduction to Statistics; Discourse Analysis; Sociolinguistics; Technical Writing.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

MA Thesis Researcher

Faculty of Education, UIII

Depok, Indonesia

Sep 2022 – Aug 2024

- Designed and carried out a qualitative case study of twelve school principals in Pakistan on leading schools through the Single National Curriculum reform.
- Led the study from research design through data collection, thematic analysis, and write-up.
- Published findings as a single-authored article (Ayaz, 2024, listed below).

Research Intern

SEAMEO CECCEP

Bandung, Indonesia

Aug 2023

- Carried out comparative policy analysis of early childhood education governance across 11 ASEAN countries under the supervision of Prof. Vina Adriany, PhD, Director of SEAMEO CECCEP.
- Contributed to the policy briefs produced from this analysis.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles, education and policy

Ayaz, M. (2024). Leadership challenges in developing countries: A case study of Pakistani higher secondary schools. *Jurnal Riset Pendidikan dan Pengajaran*, 3(1), 64–78.

Junejo, S., & Ayaz, M. (2024). Human capital for economic development: A study of education production performance (EPP) in Khairpur. *Cognizance Journal of Multidisciplinary Studies*, 4(2), 232–242.

Bouchouk, O., & Ayaz, M. (2024). The relationship between Islamic teachings and cultural values in shaping attitudes towards gender roles in Indonesia. *ROMEO: Review of Multidisciplinary Education, Culture and Pedagogy*, 3(3), 211–217.

Numan, M., & Ayaz, M. (2024). Assessing the impact and challenges of English as a medium of instruction in Indonesian higher education: A pathway to global integration or a barrier to local identity? *Transformational Language, Literature, and Technology Overview in Learning (TRANSTOOL)*, 3(3), 1–19.

Numan, M., & Ayaz, M. (2023). Unveiling cultural narratives: A qualitative inquiry into cultural representation in language education under Pakistan's Single National Curriculum. *The Journal of Cultural Perspectives*, 2(2).

Rozak, D. L., & Ayaz, M. (2023). Curriculum innovation in language instruction: Adapting to changing learner needs. *Transformational Language, Literature, and Technology Overview in Learning (TRANSTOOL)*, 2(4), 22–35.

Peer-reviewed journal articles, English literature

Iftikhar, S., Qureshi, A. W., & Ayaz, M. (2025). To be or to belong: Exploring the consciousness of being in Shafak's *The Island of Missing Trees* through Sartrean existentialism. *Journal of Humanities, Social Sciences and Business*, 4(4), 887–893.

Ayaz, M., & Numan, M. (2024). Depression as a serious human dilemma in the novel *Moth Smoke* by Mohsin Hamid. *Journal of Humanities, Social Sciences and Business*, 3(3), 734–751.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

English Language Instructor and Digital Literacy Trainer <i>English Access Microscholarship Program (U.S. Dept. of State), AWKUM (Part-time)</i>	Mardan, Pakistan May 2025 – Mar 2026
- Taught English to learners from low-income backgrounds using a curriculum aligned with U.S. Department of State program objectives. - Taught digital literacy and ran capacity-building workshops for EFL teachers on technology-supported instruction. - Awarded a Master Trainer certificate at a Regional English Language Office (RELO) capacity-building workshop for English teachers (2025).	
Mentor <i>Dahuni Foundation Mentorship Program (Part-time, voluntary)</i>	Remote May 2025 – Present
Mentor Indonesian university students one-to-one on scholarship applications, academic writing, and research skills.	
English Language and Literature Teacher <i>Army Public Schools & Colleges System (APSACS) (Full-time)</i>	Mardan, Pakistan Sep 2018 – Jul 2022
- Taught English language and literature to Grades 9–12, including structured examination preparation. - Organised inter-school debates, public-speaking competitions, and literacy activities. - Best English Teacher Award (2021); Grooming Excellence Award (2021); Certificate of Academic Excellence (2020).	

CONFERENCES AND ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

• Presenter, First and Second Faculty of Education Annual Conferences, UIII, Indonesia	2022, 2023
• Speaker, In-House Training on Multimodality in English Teaching-Learning, SIT Al-Fatih 1, Tangerang, Indonesia	2024
• Guest Teacher, SMALKI FUNTASTIC program, SMAIT Al Haraki, Citra Raya, Indonesia	2023
• Participant, Summer Course Program, Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Malang, Indonesia	2024
• Participant, Innovative Approaches in Literacy Teaching lectures, UIII and Deakin University	2023
• Participant, Writing for Academic Publication Workshop, UIII	2023
• Participant, First International Conference on Interfaith Peace Leadership, UIII	2023
• Participant, Oxford Teacher's E-Symposium, University of Oxford (online)	2022
• Participant, 1st International Multidisciplinary Graduate Conference, Bilquis Postgraduate College	2019

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

• TESOL Professional Certificate (8-course specialization), Arizona State University via Coursera	2026
• OPEN Professional Development for Teacher Trainers MOOC, U.S. Department of State / FHI 360	2026
• TEFL Professional Certificate (120 hours, Distinction), TEFL Professional Institute	2025
• Teaching OxfordAQA International GCSE English as a Second Language, OxfordAQA	2025
• Access Teachers Training Certificate, U.S. Embassy Pakistan / RELO	2025
• Master Trainer Certificate, Capacity Building Workshop for English Teachers of Orphan Centers, English Access Scholarship Program AWKUM & University of Malakand / RELO	2025
• Short courses: Lesson Planning, Lesson Management, Safeguarding, Leadership, Digital Business Skills, British Council	2024–2025

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- Fully funded international scholarship for MA in Education, UIII, Indonesia 2022
- Best English Teacher Award; Grooming Excellence Award; Efficiency Certificate, APSACS Mardan 2021
- Certificate of Academic Excellence, APSACS Mardan 2020

RESEARCH SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

- **Research methods:** Qualitative case study design, thematic analysis, comparative policy analysis, mixed methods design, SPSS, academic writing for publication
- **Teaching and training:** EFL/ESL instruction, curriculum and lesson design, teacher workshop facilitation, technology-supported instruction
- **Languages:** Pashto (native), Urdu (fluent), English (professional working proficiency; English-medium BS and MA)

REFEREES

Dr Bambang Sumintono

Head of PhD Study Program, Faculty of Education, Universitas Islam Internasional Indonesia, Depok, Indonesia

- Relationship: MA thesis co-supervisor — Email: bambang.sumintono@uiii.ac.id

Dr Abdullah Sahin

Reader in Islamic Education, University of Warwick, United Kingdom

- Email: a.sahin@warwick.ac.uk

Dr Mujahid Shah

Coordinator, English Access Scholarship Program, Abdul Wali Khan University Mardan, Pakistan

- Email: mujahidshah@awkum.edu.pk